

QUESTIONNAIRE - QUESTIONS

Communication that works well is one of the prime assets of an organisation. This research project is one of the largest in the world and will be of great importance for gaining new knowledge about organisations' communication. The questionnaire has been compiled by researchers at the Department of Strategic Communication, Lund University. The study includes both companies and public organisations.

Below, you can answer questions and assertions about communication at your workplace and about your work organisation. Because leadership properties and communication properties overlap, several of the themes comprise questions about leadership and communication together. When the top management is referred to in the questionnaire, this means the organisation's top management and/or corporate group management.

Remember that no answer is right or wrong. All information will be treated confidentially. Each organisation will receive the results and will also be able to compare its organisation's results with other results in the research project. The questionnaire can be completed in about 10 minutes.

If you would like to know more about the study, please contact Project Leader Mats Heide – Mats.Heide@isk.lu.se or 0730-799 567.

How to fill in the paper survey

Below you can see how you mark an answer option in the check boxes, and how you change a selection.

- ☒ The answer option has been marked correctly
- ☒ The answer option has been marked incorrectly, the cross must be in the middle of the box
- ☒ The answer option has been marked incorrectly, the cross is too strong
- ☒ Changed selection, the answer option will not be counted as being marked

BACKGROUND QUESTIONS

Below are some questions about you and your background.

Gender.

- ☐ Woman
- ☐ Man
- ☐ Other gender identity

Year of birth.

Position/role/function.

- ☐ Head (responsible for personnel)
- ☐ Employee
- ☐ Communicator or equivalent (head of communications/manager or employee)



Education. Put a cross in the box for your highest education.

- ☐ Nine-year school
☐ Upper-secondary school
☐ Higher education (not university/college)
☐ University/college education
☐ Other, state ...

Education background. Your basic education. (Check several if necessary)

- ☐ University/college education, major in media and communications
☐ University/college education, major in business economics
☐ University/college education, major in political science
☐ University/college education, major in strategic communications
☐ University/college education, major in journalism
☐ Professional education within the area of communications (e.g., Berghs School of Communication, Hyper Island, IHM, folk high school programme)
☐ Individual short courses, e.g., through the Swedish Association of Communication Professionals
☐ Other university/college degree or other education, state ...

How many years have you been at this workplace?

Is Swedish your native language?

- ☐ Yes
☐ No

COMMUNICATION CHANNELS AND INTERNAL COMMUNICATION

Below are some assertions about internal communication in the organisation. *Check the alternatives that are closest to your opinion.*



	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
It is easy to find the information I need for my work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is difficult to handle the quantity of information I receive in my work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is possible to submit points of view to management and heads.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The internal communication channels are primarily a tool for the management to reach out with their information.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Use

Below are questions about communication channels that are used within the organisation. *Check the alternative that corresponds most closely with your opinion.*

How *satisfied* are you with the following communication channels in your organisation?

	Unsatisfied	Rather unsatisfied	Neither nor	Rather satisfied	Satisfied	No opinion
Meetings	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Intranet	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Staff magazine	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Notice boards	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
E-mail	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Newsletter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The external website	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Immediate superior	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My colleagues	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



How *important* for your work are the communication channels listed below?

	Unimportant	Rather unimportant	Neither nor	Rather important	Important	No opinion
Meetings	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Intranet	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Staff magazine	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Notice boards	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
E-mail	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Newsletter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The external website	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Immediate superior	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My colleagues	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Opinions about internal communication

Below are some assertions about how you view internal communication in the organisation. *Check the alternative closest to your opinion.*



	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
I have access to the information I need for performing my work tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I always have access to information about current events in the organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have a clear picture of the organisation's general vision and objectives.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
When there are major changes I always receive relevant information.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Communication between different departments and /or units in the organisation works well.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I can rely on the information which comes from the management.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The top management withholds important information from the employees.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The employees withhold important information from the management.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
There is a high ceiling in the organisation, i.e., I can express my opinions freely.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I rely on the information that is on the Intranet, in the newsletter and in other internal communication channels.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My workplace is characterised by participation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Rumours among the employees are a problem in the organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
At my workplace we often discuss what is said about the organisation in <i>TV, newspapers</i> and other <i>external channels</i> .	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
At my workplace we discuss what is happening in the <i>outside world</i> and how it affects the organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
At my workplace we often discuss what our <i>meetings</i> ought to be like.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
At my workplace there are clear guidelines how <i>e-mail</i> should be used.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
At my workplace we often discuss how <i>social media</i> (e.g., Facebook, Twitter and Instagram) should be used.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
At my workplace we often discuss demands and expectations of <i>customer / citizen / user / patient</i> on our activities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

If you have any comments, write them here.



LEADERS, EMPLOYEES AND COMMUNICATION

Below are some questions about management, employee issues and communication. *Check the alternative closest to your opinion.*

My immediate superior ☐

	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
My immediate superior is accessible.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior is good at giving constructive feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior is open for feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior communicates clear objectives for our operations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior supports me in my daily work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior explains what the consequences are for my work of what happens in the organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior invites for dialogue on important matters.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



My immediate superior ☐

	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
My immediate superior is accessible.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior is good at giving constructive feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior is open for feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior communicates clear objectives for our operations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior supports me in my leadership role.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior gives me insight into important issues.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My immediate superior invites for dialogue on important issues.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

My role as employee

	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
I contribute to initiating good dialogue in my work group.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I give negative opinions in my work group if necessary.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I often give feedback to my colleagues at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am responsible for keeping myself informed about what is happening in the organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I often say good things about the organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I know what responsibilities I have as regards communication.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



The management

	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
I have considerable confidence in the top management.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The top management provides clear information to the employees.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The top management has good insight into what is happening in the organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I keep updated about the work of the top management through the internal channels.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

My leadership

How do you perceive your own communication and yourself as leader?

	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
I am accessible for my employees.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am good at giving constructive feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am open for criticism.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I communicate clear objectives for our operations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I support my employees in the daily work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I explain what is happening in the operation and what it means for our work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I invite for dialogue about important issues.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I often speak well of the organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communication responsibility in my leadership role is clear.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I clarify my employees' communication responsibilities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



Employee issues

Here are some assertions about the employees you are responsible for as regards personnel issues.

	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
I have great confidence in my employees.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My employees contribute to good dialogue at the workplace.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My employees dare to give me negative information.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My employees often give one another feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

VIEWS ABOUT COMMUNICATION AND THE COMMUNICATORS

Below are some questions about communication and the work of the communicators. *Check the alternative closest to your opinion.*



	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
Communication is an increasingly important success factor for organisations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Communicative ability is an increasingly important competence in working life.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators' work contributes to efficient <i>internal</i> communication.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators' work contributes to efficient <i>external</i> communication.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators make my work easier.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The task of the communicators in the organisation is clear.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Without communication that works well we cannot achieve our business / operations objectives.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We put too many resources into communication in relation to what we get from it.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
Communication is an increasingly important success factor for organisations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Communicative ability is an increasingly important competence in working life.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators' work contributes to efficient <i>internal</i> communication.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators' work contributes to efficient <i>external</i> communication.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators make my work easier.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The task of the communicators in the organisation is clear.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators provide important support to the heads in our organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The head of communication (or equivalent) has an important role in the management group.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We put too many resources into communication compared with what we get from it.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
Communication is an increasingly important success factor for organisations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Communicative ability is an increasingly important competence in working life.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators' work contributes to efficient internal communication.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators' work contributes to efficient external communication.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The task of the communicators in the organisation is clear.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The communicators provide important support to the heads in our organisation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The head of communications (or equivalent) has an important role in the management group.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We put too many resources into communication compared with what we get out of it.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



What do you perceive as the communicators' principal areas of competence (what they are perceived to be best at)? Choose a maximum of three alternatives.

- ☐ Writing and formulating text
- ☐ Graphic design
- ☐ Coaching heads in their communications role
- ☐ Communication plans
- ☐ Brand communication
- ☐ Change communication
- ☐ Crisis communication
- ☐ Media relations
- ☐ Work with communication channels (web, Intranet, social media, staff magazine)
- ☐ Supporting the communication of various project groups (presentation, press information, etc.)
- ☐ Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)
- ☐ Financial communication (Investor Relations)
- ☐ Lobbying (Public Affairs)
- ☐ No particular area of competence

If you have any comments, write them here.

COMMUNICATION WORK



What communications-related areas do you consider *the most important* for your organisation being able to achieve its general business/operations objectives? *Choose a maximum of three.*

- ☐ Brand work
- ☐ Media relations
- ☐ Change communication
- ☐ Financial communication (Investor Relations)
- ☐ Consumer/customer/user/citizen communications
- ☐ Lobbying (Public Affairs)
- ☐ Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)
- ☐ External website
- ☐ Social media
- ☐ Leadership communication (support for leaders)
- ☐ Crisis communication
- ☐ Intranet
- ☐ Internal meetings
- ☐ Evaluate various kinds of communication input
- ☐ External monitoring - collection, analysis and dissemination
- ☐ Initiate relations with important interested parties
- ☐ Work with basic values
- ☐ Other, state ...



What communications-related areas are in greatest *need of development and improvement* in the organisation? *Choose a maximum of three.*

- ☐ Brand work
- ☐ Media relations
- ☐ Change communication
- ☐ Financial communication, (Investor Relations)
- ☐ Consumer/customer/user/citizen communications
- ☐ Lobbying, (Public Affairs)
- ☐ Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)
- ☐ External website
- ☐ Social media
- ☐ Leadership communication (support for leaders)
- ☐ Crisis communication
- ☐ Intranet
- ☐ Internal meetings
- ☐ Evaluate various kinds of communication input
- ☐ External monitoring - collection, analysis and dissemination
- ☐ Initiate relations with important interested parties
- ☐ Work with basic values
- ☐ Other, state ...

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What three areas do you think you work with most? (Select the most resources in the form of time and money.)

- ☐ Brand work
- ☐ Media relations
- ☐ Change communication
- ☐ Financial communication, (Investor Relations)
- ☐ Consumer/customer/user/citizen communications
- ☐ Lobbying, (Public Affairs)
- ☐ Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)
- ☐ External website
- ☐ Social media
- ☐ Leadership communication (support for leaders)
- ☐ Crisis communication
- ☐ Intranet
- ☐ Internal meetings
- ☐ Evaluate various kinds of communication input
- ☐ External monitoring - collection, analysis and dissemination
- ☐ Initiate relations with important interested parties
- ☐ Work with basic values
- ☐ Other, state ...

At present, how often do you measure the effects of the communication activities that are implemented in the organisation?

- ☐ Never ☐ Almost never ☐ Sometimes ☐ Almost always ☐ Always

What is your perception of the importance given to communication activities by the top management in the organisation?

- ☐ Not important ☐ Not very important ☐ Neither nor ☐ Rather important
☐ Very important

What is your perception of the importance given to communication activities by the employees in the organisation?

- ☐ Not important ☐ Not very important ☐ Neither nor ☐ Rather important
☐ Very important

THE COMMUNICATOR – PROFESSIONAL ROLE



	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
My role at present primarily involves publishing information in various channels.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My role at present primarily involves working with plans, strategies and policies.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My role at present primarily involves providing advice and leadership support.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training gives me sufficient competence to perform my work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Communicators in my organisation who are women ...

	Disagree	Partly disagree	Neither nor	Partly agree	Agree	No opinion
... must perform better than men to have the same success and career.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... must work harder than men to ensure good relations with heads and the management group.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... have fewer career opportunities than men despite having the same qualifications.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... get less support from mentors than men.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... encounter invisible barriers that impede their career opportunities more often than do men.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

THE COMMUNICATOR AND THE FUTURE



Here are some assertions about how the profession will develop in the future. Which of the following assertions do you agree with? In five years ... *Choose the three assertions that you consider most probable.*

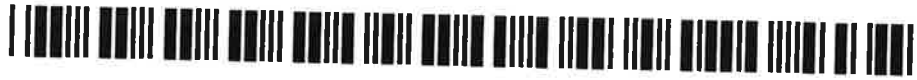
- ☐ ... there will be more communicators in companies and public organisations.
- ☐ ... the status of communicators in organisations will be much higher.
- ☐ ... there will be more communicators in organisations working with production in various channels.
- ☐ ... the number of communicators working as leadership support, advisors and/or strategists will decline.
- ☐ ... the communications head will be head of both communicators and marketing personnel in an organisation.
- ☐ ... greater knowledge of organisation, finance and management will be required.
- ☐ ... greater knowledge of politics and society will be required.
- ☐ ... cooperation between human resources specialists, marketing personnel and communicators will be greater than at present.
- ☐ ... the need for communicators to continue their training will diminish.
- ☐ ... the need for external advice will increase.
- ☐ ... the management group will include more communication heads.

Choose the three factors that you think will be the most important for communications departments in five years' time.

- ☐ Strengthen the role of the communications department in supporting top management's decision-making.
- ☐ Handle sustainability issues and CSR.
- ☐ Handle digital media and the social web.
- ☐ Support organisational change.
- ☐ Work with crises.
- ☐ Match the need to handle several target groups and channels with limited resources,
- ☐ Build and maintain confidence.
- ☐ Handle the demand for more transparency and active target groups.
- ☐ Handle the increase in speed and increase in the quantity of information.
- ☐ Represent employees' perspectives in relation to the management.
- ☐ Represent the perspectives of external interested parties.

If you have any comments, write them here.

THE IMAGE OF THE ORGANISATION



General external perceptions of the organisation

Two opposites are presented below. On the scale below, check the ones that best conform to your opinion. First there are some assertions about the perception of the organisation by the general public, and after that some assertions about the perception held by external persons who you meet in the course of your work.

I think that the general public perceives the organisation as:

Incompetent ☐	Partly incompetent ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly competent ☐	Competent ☐	No opinion ☐
Irresponsible ☐	Partly irresponsible ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly responsible ☐	Responsible ☐	No opinion ☐
Closed ☐	Partly closed ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly open ☐	Open ☐	No opinion ☐
Inefficient ☐	Partly inefficient ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly efficient ☐	Efficient ☐	No opinion ☐
Unreliable ☐	Partly unreliable ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly reliable ☐	Reliable ☐	No opinion ☐
Invisible ☐	Partly invisible ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly visible ☐	Visible ☐	No opinion ☐

I think that the *external* persons with whom I have *contact* in the course of my work perceive the organisation as:

Incompetent ☐	Partly incompetent ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly competent ☐	Competent ☐	No opinion ☐
Irresponsible ☐	Partly irresponsible ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly responsible ☐	Responsible ☐	No opinion ☐
Closed ☐	Partly closed ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly open ☐	Open ☐	No opinion ☐



Inefficient ☐	Partly inefficient ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly efficient ☐	Efficient ☐	No opinion ☐
Not reliable ☐	Partly not reliable ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly reliable ☐	Reliable ☐	No opinion ☐
Invisible ☐	Partly invisible ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly visible ☐	Visible ☐	No opinion ☐

The media image

Below are some assertions about how the organisation is presented in various media. *Check the alternative closest to your opinion.*

What I read or hear in press, radio and TV about the organisation is:

Incorrect ☐	Partly incorrect ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly correct ☐	Correct ☐	No opinion ☐
Unfair ☐	Partly unfair ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly fair ☐	Fair ☐	No opinion ☐
Not balanced ☐	Partly not balanced ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly balanced ☐	Balanced ☐	No opinion ☐

What I see in social media (e.g., Facebook, Twitter and blogs) is:

Incorrect ☐	Partly incorrect ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly correct ☐	Correct ☐	No opinion ☐
Unfair ☐	Partly unfair ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly fair ☐	Fair ☐	No opinion ☐
Not balanced ☐	Partly not balanced ☐	Neither nor ☐	Partly balanced ☐	Very balanced ☐	No opinion ☐



The media image and my work

Below are some assertions about how the organisation is presented in the traditional mass media (radio, TV and press). *Check the alternative closest to your opinion.*

	Disappointment	Some disappointment	Neither nor	Some pride	Pride	No opinion
The image of the organisation presented in the mass media (radio, TV and press) make me feel:	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	More difficult	Partly more difficult	Neither nor	Partly easier	Easier	No opinion
The image of the organisation presented in the mass media makes my work:	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not important	Not very important	Neither nor	Quite important	Important	No opinion
In relation to my work, the mass media image of the organisation is:	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Never	Not often	Neither nor	Quite often	Often	No opinion
I am often asked (by customers, residents, users and other external contacts) about things they have heard or read about in the mass media about our organisation:	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Never	Not often	Neither nor	Quite often	Often	No opinion
When I encounter rumours about the organisation that are incorrect I try to refute and correct them:	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

If you have any comments, write them here.



A big thank you for having taken the time to answer the questions!

If you have any queries please contact Project Leader Mats Heide. mats.heide@isk.lu.se
0730-799 567